

TMS, DMS and CMS Usage Guide for Falcon BMS 4.38.1

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Version 0.4.2.0+19 February 2026 | Progress: Chapters 0/7 | Tables 0 | January 2026

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Chapter 1

CMS – Countermeasures Management Switch

1.1 Concept

The Countermeasures Management Switch (CMS) is a four-direction hat switch mounted on the side-stick controller. It controls the aircraft's defensive avionics:

- ALE-47 CMDS (Countermeasures Dispenser Set) — the chaff and flare dispensing system; and
- ECM (Electronic Countermeasures) — either external pods (ALQ-131/ALQ-184) or internal avionics (IDIAS) configurations, depending on block and variant.

CMS actuation procedures are presented in [Section 1.2](#) and block and variant differences in [Section 1.3](#).

For complete CMDS and ECM operation, see *TO 1F-16CMAM-34-1-1*, Dash-34, sections 2.7.1 and 2.7.2, respectively. Diagrams of the side-stick controller and throttle functions are provided in Dash-34 § 2.1.5. [Figure 1.1](#) below shows the CMS location on the F-16 side-stick controller.



Figure 1.1: F-16 Throttle and Side-Stick Controller. Image by Falconpedia (falcon4.wikidot.com), via Wikimedia Commons (https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:F-16_Side_Stick_Controller.jpg), licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution-Share Alike 3.0 Unported (CC BY-SA 3.0) license.

1.2 CMS Actuation

The tables below cover CMS actuation organized by system: CMDS (Manual, Automatic, Semi-Automatic, Bypass, and Standby modes) and ECM (external pods ALQ-131/ALQ-184 and internal IDIAS).

All CMS actuation described in this chapter is *independent* of the Master Mode (NAV, A-A or A-G) selected.

Table columns are defined as follows:

- **Mode:** The operational context (Master Mode).
- **Direction:** CMS hat direction (Up, Down, Left, Right).
- **Action:** Press type (Short, Long, Long Hold).
- **Function:** What the CMS command activates or controls.
- **Effect / Nuance:** Resulting system behavior, including tactics and constraints.
- **Dash34:** Reference section in the Dash-34 manual.
- **Training:** Recommended BMS training mission(s) (see BMS Training Manual 4.38.1 for descriptions).

1.2.1 CMDS

The ALE-47 CMDS operates in five modes selected via the CMDS CCU MODE knob: Manual (MAN), Automatic (AUTO), Semi-Automatic (SEMI), Bypass (BYP), and Standby (STBY). The program executed in MAN, AUTO, and SEMI modes — Programs 1–4 — is selected via the PRGM knob on the CMDS panel. The PRGM knob has no effect in BYP or STBY.

Only Programs 1–4 are selectable. Programs 5 and 6 are independent of the PRGM knob position:

- Program 5 is activated via the cockpit slap switch — outside the scope of CMS — and is not covered in this guide; see Dash-34 § 2.7.2 for details.
- Program 6 is a special-purpose program always available for manual dispensing, independent of the PRGM knob position.

1.2.1.1 Manual Mode

In Manual (MAN) mode, the pilot runs countermeasure programs (1–4 and 6) via **CMS Up** and **CMS Left**.

Table 1.1: CMS Actuation with CMDS Manual Mode

Mode	Dir.	Act.	Function	Effect / Nuance	Dash34	Train.
CMDS MAN	Up	Short	Execute Program 1–4	Runs the program selected via the CMDS panel PRGM knob once per press. No threat sensing; no automatic triggering. Overrides any AUTO dispensing, if running.	2.7.2.2	18, 28
CMDS MAN	Left	Short	Execute Program 6	Program 6 can be dispensed independently of the PRGM knob position.	2.7.2.2	19

1.2.1.2 Automatic Mode

In Automatic (AUTO) mode, the ALE-47 CMDS dispenses the selected program (1–4) *continuously* in response to threats detected by the Radar Warning Receiver (RWR).

A **CMS Down** press grants consent for AUTO dispensing to start. It will continue until the pilot presses **CMS Right** or expendables are exhausted.

Even in AUTO mode, manual dispensing is still available.

Table 1.2: CMS Actuation with CMDS Automatic Mode

Mode	Dir.	Act.	Function	Effect / Nuance	Dash34	Train.
CMDS AUTO	Up	Short	Execute Program 1–4	Runs the program selected via the CMDS panel PRGM knob once, interrupting any ongoing AUTO dispensing. After execution, AUTO resumes if the threat persists.	2.7.2.2	18, 28
CMDS AUTO	Left	Short	Execute Program 6	Program 6 is dispensed independently of the PRGM knob position. Overrides AUTO; after execution, AUTO resumes.	2.7.2.2	19
CMDS AUTO	Down	Short	Give Consent; Enable AUTO Dispensing	Grants consent for AUTO dispensing. RWR-detected threats trigger automatic execution of the program (1–4) selected via the CMDS panel PRGM knob. Dispensing continues until the threat clears, the pilot presses CMS Right, or expendables are exhausted. Consent state persists if the pilot switches to MAN mode. If the pilot re-engages AUTO, dispensing resumes immediately on the next detected threat.	2.7.2.1	18, 28
CMDS AUTO	Right	Short	Cancel Consent; Disable AUTO	Removes CMDS consent and places the ALE-47 in Standby. Automatic dispensing halts immediately. The pilot must press CMS Down again to resume AUTO operation.	2.7.2.1	18, 28

1.2.1.3 Semi-Automatic Mode

In Semi-Automatic (SEMI) mode, the CMDS control unit displays DISPENSE RDY and sounds a COUNTER voice message when a threat is detected. A **CMS Down** press grants consent and the ALE-47 CMDS then dispenses *one program*.

If the threat persists or a new threat appears, the CMDS issues COUNTER again.

Even in SEMI mode, manual dispensing is still available.

Table 1.3: CMS Actuation with CMDS Semi-Automatic Mode

Mode	Dir.	Act.	Function	Effect / Nuance	Dash34	Train.
CMDS SEMI	Up	Short	Execute Program 1–4	Runs the program selected via the CMDS panel PRGM knob once, independent of RWR threat state. After execution, the CMDS returns to standby and resumes threat detection.	2.7.2.2	18, 28
CMDS SEMI	Left	Short	Execute Program 6	Program 6 is dispensed independently of the PRGM knob position. After execution, the CMDS returns to standby and resumes threat detection.	2.7.2.2	19
CMDS SEMI	Down	Short	Give Consent; Dispense One Program	Dispenses one program (1–4) in response to a COUNTER prompt. If the threat persists or a new threat appears, the CMDS issues COUNTER again. Consent state is retained: if the pilot switches to AUTO, the CMDS begins dispensing immediately on the next detected threat.	2.7.2.1	18, 28
CMDS SEMI	Right	Short	Cancel Consent; Return to Standby	Removes SEMI consent and places the CMDS in Standby. COUNTER messages cease.	2.7.2.1	18, 28

1.2.1.4 Bypass and Standby Modes

In BYP and STBY, both *non-combat modes*, AUTO and SEMI dispensing are not available. Consent state is not tracked in either mode.

Bypass (BYP): In BYP, the CMDS program selection is bypassed: **CMS Up** dispenses exactly one chaff and one flare per press. Program 6 remains available via **CMS Left**.

Table 1.4: CMS Actuation with CMDS Bypass Mode

Mode	Dir.	Act.	Function	Effect / Nuance	Dash34	Train.
CMDS BYP	Up	Short	Dispense One Chaff + One Flare	The PRGM knob setting has no effect. AUTO and SEMI dispensing are not available in BYP.	2.7.2.1	—
CMDS BYP	Left	Short	Execute Program 6	Program 6 dispenses independently of the PRGM knob position.	2.7.2.2	—

Standby (STBY): In STBY, CMDS programs and bingo quantities can be edited via the UFC. This mode inhibits all chaff and flare release: *no* CMS direction produces a dispensing effect. For program editing procedures, see Dash-34 § 2.7.2.1 and Dash-34 § 2.7.2.3.

1.2.2 ECM

The ECM system operates in two configurations: *external* pods (ALQ-131, ALQ-184), controlled via **CMS Down**, and *internal* IDIAS, controlled via **CMS Left**.

1.2.2.1 External ECM Pod (ALQ-131/ALQ-184)

With the ECM pod power switch in OPR, the XMIT switch on the ECM control panel sets the operation mode:

- XMIT 1: Avionics Priority, AFT antenna only
- XMIT 2: ECM Priority, both FWD and AFT antennas
- XMIT 3: Active Jam, continuous transmission

CMS Down grants consent for ECM pod transmission and the ECM Enable light on the left miscellaneous panel illuminates.

Table 1.5: CMS Actuation with External ECM Pod

Mode	Dir.	Act.	Function	Effect / Nuance	Dash34	Train.
ECM Pod	Down	Short	Grant ECM Consent	The pod transmits in the operation mode set by the XMIT switch. Transmission continues until the pilot presses CMS Right or the RF switch is moved out of NORM.	2.7.4.1.1, 2.7.4.2.5	28
ECM Pod	Right	Short	Remove ECM Consent	ECM consent is removed. The pod is placed in Standby and the ECM Enable light extinguishes. The pilot must press CMS Down again to resume transmission.	2.7.4.1.1, 2.7.4.2.5	28

1.2.2.2 Internal ECM (IDIAS)

With the XMTR switch in OPER, **CMS Left** cycles the IDIAS ECM operation mode. The active mode is displayed on the HUD, FCR, RWR, and TFR pages.

Table 1.6: CMS Actuation with Internal ECM (IDIAS)

Mode	Dir.	Act.	Function	Effect / Nuance	Dash34	Train.
IDIAS ECM	Left	Short	Cycle ECM Operation Mode	The IDIAS mode advances with each short press: STBY → AVNC (Avionics Priority) → ECM (ECM Priority) → AVNC → ECM .	2.7.4.1.2	28
IDIAS ECM	Right	Short	Set ECM to Standby	IDIAS is set to STBY . The pilot must press CMS Left again to return to AVNC or ECM .	2.7.4.1.2	28

1.2.3 CMDS and ECM Joint Consent

On aircraft equipped with an external ECM pod, **CMS Down** grants consent to *both* the ALE-47 CMDS (in AUTO or SEMI mode) and the external ECM pod. This joint consent applies to AUTO and SEMI *only*.

Table 1.7: CMS Interaction with CMDS and ECM (Consent and Constraints)

Mode	Dir.	Act.	Function	Effect / Nuance	Dash34	Train.
CMDS AUTO SEMI + ECM Pod	Down	Short	Joint Consent (CMDS + ECM)	Simultaneous consent to CMDS and the external ECM pod.	2.7.2.1, 2.7.4.2.5	18, 28

1.2.4 Constraints and Edge Cases

State Tracking: In AUTO and SEMI modes, consent state is not cleared when MAN mode is selected. If the pilot re-engages AUTO or SEMI without pressing **CMS Down**, the CMDS begins dispensing immediately on the next detected threat. BYP and STBY modes do not have a consent state, so switching to either mode does not retain any prior consent.

Bingo Quantity Behavior: In AUTO mode, the CMDS continues dispensing when expendables fall to or below the bingo quantity. The pilot must press **CMS Right** to disable AUTO dispensing, or switch to MAN mode.

RF Switch Override: When ECM consent is active, the ECM system is placed in Standby if the RF switch is moved from NORM to QUIET or SILENT. Consent is *not* restored when the RF switch is returned to NORM. The pilot must press **CMS Down** again to resume ECM transmission.

IDIAS vs. External ECM Pod: The joint consent described in [Section 1.2.3](#) applies to external ECM pod configurations *only*. On IDIAS-equipped aircraft, ECM modes are cycled with **CMS Left** and **CMS Down** has no function.

Ground Safety: On the ground, if the pilot holds **CMS Down**, the ECM pod may radiate. Ground personnel must be clear of the radiation area.

1.3 ECM Configuration by Block and Variant

CMS interaction with CMDS is *uniform* across all F-16 block and variant configurations (see [Section 1.2.1](#)).

F-16 block and variant configurations with external pod ECM, however, use *different* CMS procedures and ECM control panels (see [Section 1.2.2](#)):

Table 1.8: ECM Configuration by Block and Variant

ECM Configuration	CMS Direction	Panel Control
External Pod (ALQ-131/ALQ-184)	CMS Down (consent)	XMIT switch (positions: 1, 2, 3)
Internal IDIAS	CMS Left (mode cycling)	XMTR switch (positions: STBY, OPER)

1.3.1 ECM Configurations by Block and Variant

The block and variant configurations listed in the following tables are sourced from Dash-34 documentation. Not all may be available as selectable aircraft in Falcon BMS 4.38.1.

1.3.1.1 ECM Pods (ALQ-131/ALQ-184)

These block and variant configurations use the ECM Pod Control Panel with manual jamming program selection. For detailed procedures, see [Section 1.2.2.1](#).

Table 1.9: External ECM Pod Blocks and Variants

Operator	Block/Variant
USAF	Blocks 40/42/50/52 (CM designation)
NATO	Block 15 operators (Belgium, Denmark, Netherlands, Norway)
International	Egypt, Korea KF-16C Block 32

1.3.1.2 Internal ECM (IDIAS)

These block and variant configurations use the IDIAS ECM control panel. For detailed procedures, see [Section 1.2.2.2](#).

Table 1.10: Internal ECM (IDIAS) Blocks and Variants

Operator	Block/Variant
Israel	F-16I Sufa Block 52, Barak I Block 30, Barak II Block 40
International	Greek HAF (Blocks 50 PXII, 52 PXIII, 52+ PXIV Advanced), Korea KF-16C Block 52, Singapore F-16D Block 52